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California Legislators Announce Essay and Visual Arts Scholarship Winners

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SACRAMENTO-The California Armenian Legislative Caucus awarded six scholarships to California high school students who entered essay and arts contests. Earlier this year the Armenian Caucus invited California high school students to participate in its Annual Essay Contest. Students were asked to write a letter to Facebook CEO Mark Zuckerberg, urging that Facebook take the same course of action against denial and distorted posts regarding the 1915 Armenian Genocide as they have with the Holocaust.

First-prize, $1,000: Alex Santiago attending Walnut High School in Walnut, CA.

Second-prize, $750: Kyleen Lin attending Clovis North High School in Fresno, CA.

Third-prize, $500: Michael Karapetyan attending Castro Valley High School in Castro Valley, CA.

This year's theme Visual Arts Scholarship is "Human to Human Interaction." Submission types were limited to drawings, paintings, photographs, digital illustrations, and graphic design.

First-prize, $1,000: Lina Lee attending Milpitas High School in Milpitas, CA.

Second-prize, $750: Sophie Ludes attending Crescenta Valley High School in La Crescenta, CA.

Third-prize, $500: Daniella Brewer attending Tulare Western High School in Tulare, CA.

The Caucus continues to strive to educate Californians on Armenian American issues and celebrate the achievements of Armenian Americans in California. Members of the California Armenian Legislative Caucus include: Senate President pro Tempore Toni G. Atkins, Senate Majority Leader Bob Hertzberg, Senate Minority Leader Scott Wilk, Senator Bob Archuleta, Senator Andreas Borgeas, Senator Brian Dahle, Senator María Elena Durazo, Senator Anthony Portantino, Assembly Majority Leader Eloise Gómez Reyes, Assembly Speaker pro Tempore Kevin Mullen, Assemblymember Lisa Calderon, Assemblymember Vince Fong, Assemblymember Laura Friedman, Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel, Assemblymember Mike Gipson, Assemblymember Chris Holden, Assemblymember Tom Lackey, Assemblymember Adrin Nazarian, Assemblymember Luz Rivas, Assemblymember Blanca Rubio, and Assemblymember Suzette Valladares.

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